

Argument 1

Primary driving force is fundamentally different from a main or immediate cause

Reasoning

The first thing we must establish is what the motion actually asks us to prove.

The motion does not say that corruption in education is **the only cause** of national decline. It does not even require us to prove that education is always the largest sector in terms of money, institutions, or immediate damage.

The motion uses the much more specific phrase “**primary driving force.**”

A primary driving force is a force that operates at a **fundamental and upstream level**. It is something that shapes the conditions through which other outcomes are produced. Therefore, when we compare different forms of corruption, we cannot simply ask which one causes damage. We must ask:

Which one operates more fundamentally, affects the foundations on which other systems depend, and continues to influence outcomes over time?

This is the difference between a **major cause** and a **primary driving force**.

Corruption in the judiciary may directly weaken the administration of justice. Corruption in politics may directly weaken governance. Corruption in procurement may directly waste public resources.

But being directly harmful does not automatically make something primary.

A primary force must sit **further upstream in the causal chain**. It must influence the conditions that determine how other parts of society function.

Therefore, our comparison is not:

“Is corruption in another sector harmful?”

Of course it is.

Our comparison is:

“Does that corruption operate more fundamentally than corruption in education?”

That is the standard the Opposition has to meet.

Example

UNESCO itself places education in an unusually foundational position. UNESCO describes education as a **force for sustainable development**, and explains that education is vital not only as SDG 4 but also because it develops the capacities necessary for progress across the wider Sustainable Development Agenda.

This is important because it demonstrates that education is not being treated merely as one isolated social service. Its role extends into the achievement of broader social, economic and environmental objectives.

Linking

Therefore, our interpretation gives us a clear comparative framework.

The Opposition can identify many causes of decline.

But the Government is asking a deeper question:

Which problem attacks a more fundamental layer of national development?

Once we establish that **education itself is foundational to sustainable development**, corruption in the system responsible for delivering that education becomes a candidate for being *primary*, rather than merely another important cause.

And that brings us to our second argument.

Argument 2

Education is primary because knowledge, skills, values and habits are the foundations of sustainable development

Reasoning

Before discussing any country, we must understand what education actually is.

Education is the process of acquiring and sharing knowledge, skills, values, and habits.

These are not four random benefits that education happens to provide.

They are the **fundamental capacities through which individuals understand the world, make decisions, act within society, and respond to long-term challenges.**

First, **knowledge** allows individuals to understand how the world works. Sustainable development requires people to understand economic, social and environmental problems and the relationships between them. UNESCO specifically states that learners require knowledge, skills, values and attitudes that empower them to contribute to sustainable development.

Second, **skills** turn knowledge into action. Knowing that a problem exists is insufficient. Individuals must be able to analyse information, solve problems, communicate, make decisions and respond to complex situations. UNESCO's Education for Sustainable Development framework explicitly emphasises competencies such as critical thinking, decision-making and collaborative participation.

Third, **values** determine how knowledge and skills are used. Sustainable development is not simply about becoming economically productive. It also requires principles such as equity, social justice, respect for human rights, peace, accountability and responsibility. UNESCO identifies such values as integral to education for sustainable development.

Fourth, **habits** determine whether those values and skills become consistent behaviour. Sustainable development requires changes in the way people live, consume, participate, make decisions and respond to social and environmental problems. UNESCO therefore describes education for sustainable development as empowering people with the knowledge, skills, values, attitudes and behaviours needed to make responsible choices for the environment, economy and society.

So these elements create a progression:

Knowledge tells us what is happening.

Skills tell us what we can do about it.

Values tell us what we should do.

Habits determine whether we repeatedly do it.

And that progression is precisely what sustainable development requires.

Sustainable development is not achieved by solving one problem once. It requires people who can **understand problems, make responsible decisions, act effectively, and sustain those actions over time.**

Example

UNESCO's Education for Sustainable Development framework explicitly connects these elements to sustainable development.

UNESCO states that education enables people to acquire the **knowledge, skills, values and attitudes** necessary to shape a sustainable future, and that education contributes to **all of the Sustainable Development Goals**, not only SDG 4.

In its Education for Sustainable Development Goals framework, UNESCO further explains that these competencies enable individuals to contribute to **societal, economic and political change** and to transform their own behaviour.

This is real-world institutional evidence of the mechanism we are establishing: education does not merely transmit information; it develops the capacities through which sustainable development is pursued.

Linking

And this is exactly why **education is primary**.

Education is primary not because it is more fashionable, more visible, or more important in rhetoric.

It is primary because the **very elements that constitute education—knowledge, skills, values and habits—are themselves the foundational capacities required for sustainable development**.

If sustainable development requires people to understand, decide, act responsibly and sustain that action, then education sits at the beginning of that process.

So our logic is:

Education develops knowledge, skills, values and habits. Those elements enable people to understand problems, make decisions, act responsibly and sustain change. Those capacities are fundamental to sustainable development. Therefore, education occupies a primary position in the causal chain of sustainable development.

Now, and only now, we bring that principle into Bangladesh.

Argument 3

No other sector can be more primary than education

Reasoning

We have already established that education is the process of acquiring and sharing **knowledge, skills, values and habits**, and that these elements are fundamental to sustainable development.

Therefore, to determine whether education is truly the **primary** driving force, we must compare it with the other sectors of a nation.

Every sector operates through people.

The judicial sector requires people with legal knowledge and reasoning.

The political sector requires people with knowledge, judgement and values.

The economic sector requires people with technical, financial and entrepreneurial skills.

The healthcare sector requires people with scientific knowledge, professional skills and ethical values.

So even when the problem exists in another sector, the ability to **operate, improve or reform that sector still depends on human beings possessing knowledge, skills, values and habits**.

And those are precisely the elements education develops.

This creates a hierarchy.

Other sectors produce **sector-specific outcomes**.

Education develops the **fundamental human capacities through which those outcomes become possible**.

Therefore, corruption in another sector can undermine that particular sector, but corruption in education can undermine the development of the very capacities required across **all sectors**.

That is what makes education more primary.

Example

This is reflected in UNESCO's framework for Education for Sustainable Development, which states that education develops the **knowledge, skills, values and attitudes** needed for people to contribute to sustainable development and that these competencies contribute across the Sustainable Development Goals rather than being confined to education alone.

So education's influence is inherently cross-sectoral.

This is also why UNESCO describes education as a **foundation of sustainable development**, rather than simply one development sector among many.

Linking

This brings us back to the exact wording of the motion.

The Opposition can identify corruption in the judiciary, politics, economy, healthcare or any other sector and demonstrate that it causes decline.

But they still face one question:

Can they identify a sector more fundamental than the one that develops the knowledge, skills, values and habits required for every other sector to function and for sustainable development to occur?

They cannot.

Because every other sector depends on people; and the capabilities of those people are developed through education.

Therefore, education is not simply *one* driving force among many.

It is the most primary driving force because it operates at the foundation of the human capacities on which all other driving forces depend.

And that gives your Government case a much cleaner progression:

1. What does “primary driving force” mean?

→ Fundamental, upstream and foundational.

2. Why is education primary?

→ Because education develops **knowledge, skills, values and habits**, which are fundamental to sustainable development.

3. Why can no other sector be more primary?

→ Because **every other sector ultimately depends on people possessing those very capacities**. Therefore, other sectors may be major drivers, but none is more **primary** than education.

Therefore, we are not claiming that education is merely the **most important sector**.

We are proving something much more specific:

Education is the most primary because it operates at the foundation of the capacities upon which all other sectors and sustainable development depend.

For that reason, corruption in education is not merely another contributor to national decline. It attacks the most primary foundation from which national development must proceed.

And that is why the Government proudly stands for the motion.